



BHARAT SOKA GAKKAI · ENTRANCE EXAM 2026

Mock Papers

Who Wants to Be a Bodhisattva · Level 1

320 QUESTIONS · 6 PAPERS · ANSWERS AT THE BACK

The four original papers, question for question, plus two exam-condition papers of forty questions drawn across all twelve topics — the same shape as the real thing. For anyone who would rather sit with a pen and paper than a phone.

Before you begin

There is no passing or failing here. We sit these papers to deepen our own conviction in faith and practice — that is the whole of it. If you are attempting the exam again this year, these pages are for you especially.

The four mock papers are the question bank exactly as it was set, grouped by topic. Work through one topic at a time if that suits you better; nothing says a paper must be done in one sitting.

The two exam-condition papers are different. Forty questions drawn across all twelve topics, mixed up, the way the real paper comes at you. Give yourself an hour, no notes, and do not look at the answers until you have attempted every question. Paper B shares no questions with Paper A, so you can sit one now and keep the other for the final week.

Attempt everything. Nothing is deducted for a wrong answer, so a blank is the only certain zero. If two options look right, choose the one that answers the question as asked.

The answers are at the back, one block per paper. Mark yourself honestly, then go back to whichever topic gave you the most trouble — that list, not a feeling, is what to revise.

THE QUIZ IS ALSO ONLINE

sunilrpappu-arch.github.io/bsg-entrance — the same questions, with the answer revealed after each one, and timed papers generated fresh every time.

Mock Paper 1

70 questions · The Life of Nichiren Daishonin · Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo · Attaining Buddhahood in This Lifetime & Kosen-rufu

THE LIFE OF NICHIREN DAISHONIN

1. The Daishonin was the first to demonstrate how to realize the ideal of the _____ to bring happiness to all people. Fill in the blank.
A Nirvana Sutra **B** Agama Sutra **C** Lotus Sutra **D** Immeasurable Meanings Sutra
2. Nichiren Daishonin was born on
A 1 Feb 1222 **B** 16 Feb 1222 **C** 16 Mar 1958 **D** 21 Sep 1278
3. He confirmed that _____ was the foremost among all the Buddhist sutras
A Nirvana Sutra **B** Agama Sutra **C** Lotus Sutra **D** Immeasurable Meanings Sutra
4. He proclaimed Nam-myoho-Renge Kyo to be the sole teaching for leading all people in the Latter Day of the Law on
A 28 Apr 1253 **B** 16 Aug 1222 **C** 1 Apr 1268 **D** 16 Feb 1279
5. He adopted the name Nichiren which means
A Sun Moon **B** North Star **C** Lotus Flower **D** Sun Lotus
6. Following the devastating earthquakes of the Shoka era he submitted a treatise called
A Opening of the eyes **B** On Establishing the correct teaching for the peace of the Land **C** On Observing One's Mind
D The Gohonzon
7. On July 16, 1260, he submitted his treatise to Hojo Tokiyori the regent of Kamakura military government. This known as
A First remonstrance **B** Second Remonstrance **C** Third Remonstrance **D** Kosen Rufu
8. Daishonin in his first remonstrance predicted two calamities of the "three calamities and seven disasters" yet to occur. What were they?
A Famine and floods **B** Internal strife and foreign invasion **C** Typhoons and earthquakes
D Pestilence and war
9. Shortly after Daishonin submitted his treatise 'on Establishing the correct teachings for the Peace of the Land', a group of Nembutsu believers stormed his dwelling in an attempt to take his life. This is called:
A Matsubagayatsu Persecution **B** Atsuhara Persecution **C** Komatsubara Persecution
D Tatsunokuchi Persecution
10. On May 12 1261, Daishonin was arrested and sentenced to exile in Ito. This is called:
A Sado Exile **B** Izu Exile **C** Kyoto Exile **D** Minobu Exile
11. He was pardoned from exile in Feb 1263 and in 1264 returned to his residence and, a band of armed men under the command of the local steward, Tojo Kagenobu attacked him and his followers in which the Daishonin sustained an injury to his forehead and broke his left hand and one of his followers was killed. This is called:
A Matsubagayatsu Persecution **B** Atsuhara Persecution **C** Komatsubara Persecution
D Tatsunokuchi Persecution

12. On September 10, 1271 the Daishonin was summoned by the government and interrogated by Hei no Saemon-no-jo Yoritsuna, the deputy chief of Military and Police affairs where the Daishonin admonished him and emphasized the proper attitude for the nation's rulers based on the correct teaching of Buddhism. Two days later, his dwelling was raided and he was arrested and treated as if he were a traitor. The events of September 10 & 12 were called:

- A** First Remonstrance **B** Second Remonstrance **C** Third Remonstrance **D** Fourth Remonstrance

13. "Every morning and evening we (who are dedicating our lives to faith in the Gohonzon) actualize the principle of _____. We cause the life of the eternal Buddha of time without beginning to manifest in our hearts..."

- A** Casting off the transient and revealing the true **B** Buddha of Beginningless time
C Oneness of self and environment **D** Three Obstacles and Four Devils

14. On Sep 12, 1271 the Daishonin was taken to be secretly beheaded. Just as the executioner raised his sword to strike, however a brilliant orb of light burst forth shooting across the sky and terrified the soldiers. They abandoned their attempt to kill the Daishonin. This event is called:

- A** Matsubagayatsu Persecution **B** Atsuhara Persecution **C** Komatsubara Persecution
D Tatsunokuchi Persecution

15. In triumphing over the Tatsunokuchi persecution, Daishonin revealed his original true identity as the Buddha of the Latter Day of the Law. This is called:

- A** Casting off the transient and revealing the true **B** Buddha of Beginningless time
C Oneness of self and environment **D** Three Obstacles and Four Devils

16. On October 10, 1271, Daishonin was sentenced to exile. He was assigned a dilapidated shrine called Sammi-do in the graveyard of Tsukahara which was used for funeral rites.

- A** Sado Exile **B** Izu Exile **C** Kyoto Exile **D** Minobu Exile

17. On Jan 16 & 17, 1272, several hundred Buddhist priests from Sado gathered intent to kill the Daishonin but a religious debate was proposed instead by Homma Shigetsura, in which Daishonin thoroughly refuted the erroneous teachings of the various Buddhist schools of the day. This debate is called:

- A** Otaru Debate **B** Tsukahara Debate **C** Sado Debate **D** Izo Debate

18. In 1272, a faction of the ruling Hojo clan rose up in rebellion and fighting broke out in Kamakura and Kyoto. Thus making Daishonin's prediction of internal strife come true. This is called:

- A** January Disturbance **B** February Disturbance **C** March Disturbance **D** April Disturbance

19. Daishonin composed many important works during his exile on Sado. Written in Feb 1272, one writing that clarifies the object of devotion in terms of the Person is called:

- A** The Opening of the Eyes **B** The Object of Devotion for Observing the Mind **C** The Selection of Time
D On Establishing the correct teachings for the peace of the land

20. Written in April 1273, the Daishonin's writing that clarifies the object of devotion in terms of the Law is called:

- A** The Opening of the Eyes **B** The Object of Devotion for Observing the Mind **C** The Selection of Time
D On Establishing the correct teachings for the peace of the land

21. In Feb 1274, the Daishonin was pardoned and in March, departed from Sado and returned to Kamakura. He met Hei no Saemon-no-jo in April and predicted that the Mongol invasion would most certainly take place before the year's end. This meeting is called:

- A** First Remonstrance **B** Second Remonstrance **C** Third Remonstrance **D** Fourth Remonstrance

22. Just as the Daishonin predicted, a large Mongol fleet attacked Kyushu in October 1274. With this, the two predictions he had made in “On Establishing the correct teachings for the peace of the land” – those of internal strife and foreign invasion - had come true. This is referred to as:
- A** First Mongol invasion **B** Second Mongol Invasion **C** Third Mongol Invasion
D Fourth Mongol Invasion
23. When the government rejected his final remonstrance, the Daishonin decided to leave Kamakura and take up residence in:
- A** Sado Island **B** Kyushu **C** Mount Minobu **D** Mount Hiei
24. He composed major works like “The Selection of Time” and “On Repaying Debts of Gratitude” in which he elucidates important teachings, in particular, the object of devotion of the essential teaching, the sanctuary of the essential teaching and the daimoku of the essential teaching. These are called:
- A** Three Great Secret Laws **B** Three Kinds of Treasure **C** Three realms of existence
D Three Bodies of the Buddha
25. On 21 Sep, 1279, 20 farmers who were followers of the Daishonin were arrested on trumped-up charges and taken to Kamakura and tortured by Hei no Saemon-no-jo to abandon their faith in the Lotus Sutra. Ultimately the three brothers – Junshiro, Yagoro and Yarokuro were executed and the remaining were banished from their places of residence. This series of events is known as:
- A** Matsubagayatsu Persecution **B** Atsuhara Persecution **C** Komatsubara Persecution
D Tatsunokuchi Persecution
26. In “Persecutions befalling a sage” dated 1 October 1279, in the 27th year of proclaiming his teachings he refers to the _____.
- A** The object of devotion for observing one’s mind **B** Purpose of his appearance in this world
C Three obstacles and four devils **D** Three powerful enemies
27. The Daishonin passed away at Ikegami Munenaka’s residence on 13 Oct, 1282 at the age of 61. After his death, only one of his disciples carried out his mentor’s fearless spirit and actions for kosen-rufu. Who was his successor:
- A** Nikko Shonin **B** Nanjo Tokimitsu **C** Ikegami Munenaka **D** Lay Nun Sennichi

NAM-MYOHORENGE-KYO

28. Nam-myoho-enge-kyo means :
- A** The Fundamental Law that Pervades the Universe and Life **B** The Essential Law for Attaining Buddhahood
C The eternal Law inherent in All people’s lives **D** All of the Above
29. Nam stands for the Sanskrit term “Namu” meaning:
- A** To devote one’s life **B** To respect others **C** To pay obeisance **D** To fold palms in reverence
30. Myoho stands for:
- A** Secret Law **B** Mystic Law **C** Causal Law **D** Eternal Law
31. Renge means Lotus and is a metaphor for:
- A** Simultaneity of cause and effect **B** Singularity of cause and effect **C** Duality of cause and effect
D General Law of cause and effect
32. Kyo means:
- A** Sutra **B** Faith **C** Life **D** End

33. Nichiren Daishonin awakened to the truth that the Law expounded in the Lotus Sutra existed in his own life and revealed the Law to be:
- A Namu-Amida-Butsu B Buddham Sharanam Gachami C Om Namah Shivay
D Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo
34. Nam-myoho-enge-kyo is the enlightened life state of:
- A Bodhisattva B Buddhahood C Cause-Awakened Ones D Voice-Hearers
35. All people are inherently and originally _____ itself.
- A Nam-myoho-enge-kyo B Mystic beings C Supreme beings D Awakened ones
36. Nichiren Daishonin depicted his own Buddhahood or enlightened state in the form of ____
- A Mandala B Sutra C Talisman D Treatise
37. Daishonin wrote, "Never seek this _____ outside yourself. [It] exists only within the mortal flesh of us ordinary people who embrace the Lotus Sutra and chant Nam-myoho-enge-kyo." Fill in the blank.
- A Buddha B Eternal C Gohonzon D Gosho
38. In the Record of the orally transmitted teachings, The Daishonin says, "Great joy [is what] one experiences when one understands for the first time that one's mind from the very beginning has been a Buddha. _____ is the greatest of all joys." Fill in the blank.
- A Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo B Gohonzon C Buddhahood D Faith

ATTAINING BUDDHAHOOD IN THIS LIFETIME & KOSEN-RUFU

39. "...always to advance from the state of suffering to the state of _____, and then to proceed from that state to transform reality" Fill in the blank.
- A Tranquillity B Rapture C Buddhahood D Cause Awakened Ones
40. The fundametal purpose of our Buddhist faith and practice is _____.
- A Attaining Buddhahood in this lifetime B Attaining Buddhahood in one's present form
C Attaining Buddhahood by ordinary people D All of the Above
41. "In a certain sense, therefore, A Buddha is someone who is always thinking and agonizing over _____ to achieve happiness as well as how to fulfill his or her mission." Fill in the blank.
- A How to develop other's ability B How to overcome own suffering C How to create own good fortune
D How to defeat evil demons
42. "Attain" of Attaining Buddhahood means
- A To open and reveal B To acquire good fortune & benefit C To become a special human being
D To be reborn in pure land
43. The Daishonin says that "one comes to realize and see that each thing – the cherry, the plum, the peach and the damson – in its own entity, without undergoing any change, possesses the eternally endowed ____". Fill in the blank.
- A Three Bodies of the Buddha B Three realms of existence
C Three thousand realms in a single moment of life D Three Great secret Laws
44. Attaining Buddhahood is not the achievement of a final goal. The state of Buddhahood is characterized by an unremitting struggle based on faith in the mystic law to _____.
- A Acquire earthly desires B To be reborn in the pure land C Eliminate evil and generate good.
D To become a special human being

45. Attaining Buddhahood is the process of manifesting the life state of a Buddha which is originally present within all people. This is called:
- A** Attaining Buddhahood in one's present form **B** To be reborn in the pure land
C To become a superior human being **D** To become an extraordinary person
46. Mahayana sutras other than Lotus sutra teach the attainment of Buddhahood require at least two conditions. One condition is that one has to engage in Buddhist practice over repeated cycles of birth and death. The other is that one doesn't belong to which of the following groups:
- A** Voice-hearers and cause-awakened ones **B** Evil people **C** Women **D** All the above
47. By believing in the Gohonzon and continuing to exert ourselves in faith and practice for the sake of Kosen-rufu, we can manifest in our lives as ordinary people the same life state of Buddhahood as Nichiren Daishonin. This is expressed as the principles:
- A** Attaining Buddhahood in this lifetime **B** Attaining Buddhahood in one's present form
C Attaining Buddhahood by ordinary people **D** All of the Above
48. The idea of 'attaining Buddhahood in one's present form' can be expressed from another distinct perspective as the principles:
- A** Earthly desires are enlightenment **B** The sufferings of Birth and Death are Nirvana **C** Both of the above
D None of the above
49. A life tormented by earthly desires and suffering can become a life of limitless freedom that shines with enlightened wisdom, just as it is. This is the meaning of the principle:
- A** The sufferings of Birth and Death are Nirvana **B** Mutual possession of ten worlds
C Earthly desires are enlightenment **D** Cherry, plum, peach and damson
50. Though we may be in a state of suffering caused by the painful realities of birth and death, when we believe in the Gohonzon and chant Nam-myoho-enge-kyo, we can manifest in our lives the tranquil life state of the Buddha's enlightenment. This is the meaning of the principle:
- A** The sufferings of Birth and Death are Nirvana **B** Mutual possession of ten worlds
C Earthly desires are enlightenment **D** Cherry, plum, peach and damson
51. Which principle(s) teach us that when we base ourselves on faith in the mystic law, we can lead positive, proactive lives, transforming every problem and suffering we have into a cause for growth and happiness.
- A** Earthly desires are enlightenment **B** The sufferings of Birth and Death are Nirvana **C** Both of the above
D None of the above
52. A condition in which material needs are fulfilled and our personal desires satisfied is
- A** Absolute Happiness **B** Nirvana **C** Supreme Enlightenment **D** Relative Happiness
53. A state of life in which being alive itself is a source of happiness and joy, no matter where we are or what our circumstances is called:
- A** Absolute Happiness **B** Nirvana **C** Supreme Enlightenment **D** Relative Happiness
54. Attaining Buddhahood means establishing this state of _____.
- A** Absolute Happiness **B** Nirvana **C** Supreme Enlightenment **D** Relative Happiness
55. Absolute Happiness is a state which is:
- A** Is not influenced by external conditions **B** Persists eternally **C** Both of the above **D** None of the above
56. The purpose of practicing Nichiren Buddhism, in addition to attaining Buddhahood in this lifetime on an individual level, is to:
- A** Establish the sanctuary of the High Priest **B** Secure happiness of both oneself and others
C Create unimaginable wealth for successors **D** Promote Buddhism as the foremost religion

57. 'Establishing the correct teachings' means:

- A** Discarding all other religious symbols and replacing them with statues of Buddha
- B** Making the Buddhist teaching of respect for the dignity of life the motivating principle of society
- C** Erecting the statue of Buddha across all major shrines and supporting high priests
- D** Inviting the Buddhist priests into our homes to enshrine the Dai-Gohonzon

58. 'For the peace of the land' means:

- A** Defeating and capturing all dissidents
- B** Warring against all dissenting voices
- C** Discarding all weapons of mass destruction
- D** Realizing peace and prosperity in society as well as safety and security for all individuals in their daily lives

59. "If you care anything about your personal security, you should first of all pray for order and tranquility throughout _____, should you not?"

- A** The four quarters of the land
- B** The three quarters of the land
- C** The two quarters of the land
- D** The one quarter of the land

60. The aim of Buddhism is to share and spread the correct teaching that embodies the Buddha's enlightenment, and guide all people towards attaining the life state of Buddhahood, and realize peace and prosperity for all humanity. This is called:

- A** Gohonzon
- B** Kosen-rufu
- C** Itai-Doshin
- D** Gongyo

61. "After I have passed into extinction, in the last _____ you must spread it [this teaching] abroad widely throughout Jamudvipa [the entire world] and never allow it to be cut off..."

- A** Two-hundred-year period
- B** Three-hundred-year period
- C** Four-hundred-year period
- D** Five-hundred-year period

62. 'Spread it abroad widely' means:

- A** Gohonzon
- B** Kosen-rufu
- C** Itai-Doshin
- D** Gongyo

63. The last five-hundred-year period corresponds to:

- A** Former Day of the Law
- B** Middle Day of the Law
- C** Latter Day of the Law
- D** Last day of reckoning

64. In the Lotus sutra, the Buddha entrusts the mission of widespread propagation in the Latter Day of the Law to:

- A** Bodhisattvas of the Earth
- B** Bodhisattva Never Disparaging
- C** Bodhisattvas of the Essential Teaching
- D** Bodhisattvas of the Theoretical teaching

65. Who are the Buddha's disciples from the unimaginably remote past, who have thoroughly forged themselves?

- A** Bodhisattvas of the Earth
- B** Bodhisattva Never Disparaging
- C** Bodhisattvas of the Essential Teaching
- D** Bodhisattvas of the Theoretical teaching

66. The 'great vow' refers to the propagation of:

- A** Nirvana Sutra
- B** Agama Sutra
- C** Lotus Sutra
- D** Immeasurable Meanings Sutra

67. "If Nichiren's compassion is truly great and encompassing, Nam-myoho-renge-kyo will spread for...":

- A** One thousand years
- B** Two thousand years
- C** Five thousand years
- D** Ten thousand years and more, for all eternity

68. The Daishonin repeatedly urged his followers to dedicate their lives to Kosen-rufu, attain Buddhahood and actualize the principle of:

- A** On Establishing the correct teachings for the peace of the land
- B** Three obstacles and four devils
- C** Three powerful enemies
- D** Three proofs

69. "If you are of the same mind as Nichiren, you must be a _____. " Fill in the blank.

- A** Bodhisattvas of the Earth **B** Bodhisattva Never Disparaging **C** Bodhisattvas of the Essential Teaching
D Bodhisattvas of the Theoretical teaching

70. It is _____ that has made the predictions of Shakyamuni and Nichiren Daishonin of making Kosen-rufu a reality.

- A** True World School **B** Zen School **C** Tendai School **D** Soka Gakkai

Mock Paper 2

70 questions · The Ten Worlds · The Three Proofs · Faith, Practice and Study

THE TEN WORLDS

1. Ten Worlds is a classification of 10 distinct states of life and forms the foundation of the Buddhist view of life.

The first six worlds, also known as the six paths are:

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Hell, Hungry Spirits, Animals, Asuras, Human Beings and Heavenly Beings | B Stupidity, Greed, Anger, Foolishness, Learning and Realisation |
| C Calm, Rage, Fear, Aggression, Jealousy and Reason | D Cause-Awakened ones, Voice-hearers, Bodhisattvas, Mahasattvas, Boddhi-Buddhas, Buddhas |

2. The four Noble Worlds are:

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Animals, Asuras, Human Beings and Heavenly Beings | B Anger, Foolishness, Learning and Realisation |
| C Fear, Aggression, Jealousy and Reason | D Cause-Awakened ones, Voice-hearers, Bodhisattvas, Buddhas |

3. In Buddhist Sutras other than the Lotus Sutra, the ten worlds are regarded as 10 separate, fixed realms of existence. The Lotus Sutra, however, fundamentally rejects that point of view, teaching that the Ten Worlds are 10 states of life inherent within each living being. This is called:

- A** Transmigration **B** Mutual possession of Ten Worlds **C** Ten factors **D** Ten directions

4. What is the fundamental principle expounded in the Lotus sutra that enables all people to transform their state of life?

- A** Three Buddha Bodies **B** Three Proofs **C** Mutual Possession of Ten Worlds **D** Ten Factors

5. What is the life state in which we experience the world around us as a place that inflicts suffering upon us as intense as if we were being burned by flames?

- A** Hell **B** Hungry Spirits **C** Animals **D** Asuras

6. What is the life state in which living is itself extremely painful and everything we see is colored by our unhappiness and misery?

- A** Hell **B** Hungry Spirits **C** Animals **D** Asuras

7. In 'The Object of Devotion for Observing the Mind,' the Daishonin says, "_____ is the world of Hell." Fill in the blank.

- A** Rage **B** Greed **C** Anger **D** Foolishness

8. What is the life state that is characterized by relentless craving and the suffering arising from such craving going unsatisfied?

- A** Hell **B** Hungry Spirits **C** Animals **D** Asuras

9. What is the life state in which one is enslaved by desires and unable to see them for constructive, creative purposes?

- A** Hell **B** Hungry Spirits **C** Animals **D** Asuras

10. The Daishonin writes, "_____ is the world of hungry spirits." Fill in the blank.

- A** Rage **B** Greed **C** Anger **D** Foolishness

11. Which is the life state that is characterised by foolishness in the sense of being moved by impulse rather than reason and being concerned only with immediate benefit and gratification?
A Hell **B** Hunger **C** Animality **D** Anger
12. The Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of animals.” Fill in the blank.
A Rage **B** Greed **C** Anger **D** Foolishness
13. Which is the life state where one is ruled by the law of the jungle, a struggle for survival in which one is willing to harm others to stay alive, with no sense of reason or conscience?
A Hell **B** Hunger **C** Animality **D** Anger
14. Which is the life state where one is obsessed with personal superiority or self-importance, a tendency to always compare oneself with others and want to be better than them?
A Hell **B** Hunger **C** Animality **D** Anger
15. Those in this world often put on an appearance of being people of virtue and fine character, even pretending to be humble in order to impress others. Inside, however, they are filled with jealousy and resentment towards those perceived to be better than them. Which is this world?
A Hell **B** Hungry Spirits **C** Animals **D** Asuras
16. The Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of asuras.”
A Hell **B** Hunger **C** Animality **D** Perversity
17. “Perversity” means concealing one’s true feelings in order to ingratiate oneself with others. There are two aspects to this perversity. One is to fawn and deceive. What is the other?
A To feel anguish **B** To crave what others have **C** To distort reason **D** To kill or be killed
18. Which is the state that is a calm, composed state in which people maintain their characteristic human qualities?
A Animals **B** Asuras **C** Human Beings **D** Heavenly Beings
19. Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of human beings.”
A Greed **B** Foolishness **C** Rage **D** Calmness
20. Those in this life state have the capacity to distinguish right from wrong and to exercise self- control. What is this state?
A Animality **B** Anger **C** Humanity **D** Rapture
21. Which is the life state that is regarded as a condition of joy experienced when we fulfill our desires through effort?
A Animals **B** Asuras **C** Human Beings **D** Heavenly Beings
22. The Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of heaven.”
A Joy **B** Greed **C** Foolishness **D** Calmness
23. What is the life state in which we experience ‘joy’ that is not lasting? It fades and disappears with the passage of time.
A Animals **B** Asuras **C** Human Beings **D** Heavenly Beings
24. What are the worlds that are easily influenced by external circumstances called?
A Four Noble Worlds **B** Six Paths **C** Ten Directions **D** Three existences

25. Person in the two worlds of learning and realization are together referred to as:
- A** Persons of the one vehicle **B** Persons of the two vehicles **C** Persons of the three vehicles
D Persons of the four vehicles
26. Which is the life state attained by those who gain a partial awakening through hearing the Buddha's teachings?
- A** Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Bodhisattvas **D** Buddhas
27. Which is the life state attained by those who gain a partial awakening through their own observations and effort?
- A** Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Bodhisattvas **D** Buddhas
28. Which world has the limitation of self-centredness where one is self-absorbed seeking only their own enlightenment and making no effort to help others do the same?
- A** Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Both of the above **D** None of the above
29. What distinguishes those in this world is their seeking spirit to attain the highest life state of Buddhahood and their altruistic efforts to share the benefits they have obtained through Buddhist practice. Which world are we talking about?
- A** Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Bodhisattvas **D** Buddhas
30. The essence of the world of Bodhisattvas is _____.
- A** Rage **B** Foolishness **C** Compassion **D** Greed
31. When we chant Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo we can tap the life state of _____ within us.
- A** Learning **B** Realisation **C** Bodhisattva **D** Buddhahood
32. It's an expansive life state overflowing with good fortune and benefit, attained through awakening to the fact that the mystic law is the foundation of one's being. Which is this life state?
- A** Learning **B** Realisation **C** Bodhisattva **D** Buddhahood
33. The life state of Buddhahood is originally inherent in our own beings. However, it is difficult to manifest it in our daily lives, filled with unending problems and challenges. For this reason, the Daishonin inscribed the _____ as a means for all people to bring forth from within them the life state of Buddhahood. Fill in the blank.
- A** Gohonzon **B** Gosho **C** Gongyo **D** Juju Beads
34. The _____ is the enlightened life state of Nichiren Daishonin, the Buddha of the Latter Day of the Law, the essence of which is Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo. Fill in the blank.
- A** Gohonzon **B** Gosho **C** Gongyo **D** Juju Beads
35. When we believe in the Gohonzon and chant Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo for the happiness of ourselves and others, we can tap the life state of _____ within us.
- A** Learning **B** Realisation **C** Bodhisattva **D** Buddhahood
36. The Daishonin identifies the profound connection between the life state of Buddhahood and faith in the Mystic Law, saying, "The ordinary people born in the latter age can believe in the Lotus Sutra is due to the fact that the world of _____ is present in the human world." Fill in the blank.
- A** Learning **B** Realisation **C** Bodhisattva **D** Buddhahood
37. The life state of Buddhahood attained through faith in the Mystic Law can be described in contemporary terms as a state of _____ that nothing can destroy. Fill in the blank.
- A** Relative happiness **B** Absolute Happiness **C** Relative suffering **D** Absolute suffering

38. Second Soka Gakkai President Josei Toda described Buddhahood as a state of life in which being alive is itself _____. Fill in the blank.
A Happiness **B** Unhappiness **C** Painful suffering **D** Burdensome
39. The life state of Buddhahood is also often likened to the spirit of a _____ - a state of complete ease and confidence in which one fears nothing. Fill in the blank.
A Tiger King **B** Leopard King **C** Lion King **D** Monkey King

THE THREE PROOFS

40. _____ must always be for the people. People do not exist for the sake of _____. Fill in the blank.
A Religion **B** Scriptures **C** Politics **D** Sovereign
41. The _____ are the three criteria for determining the correct teaching for leading people to absolute happiness. Fill in the blank.
A Three Aspects **B** Three kinds of Treasure **C** Three Obstacles **D** Three Proofs
42. The three proofs are:
A Documentary, Theoretical and Actual **B** Documentary, Scientific, Experimental
C Word of mouth, Journalled, Published **D** Seen, Imagined, Felt
43. _____ means that a religion's doctrines are based upon or in accord with its foundational scriptures. Fill in the blank.
A Theoretical Proof **B** Documentary Proof **C** Actual Proof **D** Doctoral Proof
44. In the case of Buddhism, all doctrines must be supported by the sutras or the teachings expounded by _____. Fill in the blank.
A Avalokitasvara **B** Shakyamuni Buddha **C** Amida Buddha **D** Dharma Treasury
45. In the Soka Gakkai, the writings of _____, who practised and embodied the essence of the Lotus Sutra, serve as documentary proof. Fill in the blank.
A Nichiren Daishonin **B** Nichinyo Shonin **C** Nikken Abe **D** Nissho Shonin
46. _____ is the proof of reason which means that a religion's doctrines and assertions are compatible with reason and logic. Fill in the blank.
A Documentary Proof **B** Theoretical Proof **C** Actual Proof **D** Doctoral Proof
47. Daishonin writes, "Buddhism is _____. Fill in the blank.
A Unquestionable **B** Reason **C** Free of doubt **D** Nirvana
48. _____ means that belief and practice of a religion's doctrines produce positive results in one's life and daily affairs and in society. Fill in the Blank.
A Documentary Proof **B** Theoretical Proof **C** Actual Proof **D** Doctoral Proof
49. The Daishonin writes, "In judging the relative merit of Buddhist doctrines, I, Nichiren, believe that the best standards are those of reason and documentary proof. And even more valuable than reason and documentary proof is the proof of _____. Fill in the Blank.
A Actual Fact **B** Errors **C** Inconsistencies **D** Missing fractions
50. The Daishonin valued which proof above all other forms of proof?
A Documentary Proof **B** Theoretical Proof **C** Actual Proof **D** Doctoral Proof

FAITH, PRACTICE AND STUDY

51. "Exert yourself in the two ways of practice and study. Without practice and study, there can be no Buddhism. You must not only persevere yourself; you must also teach others. Both practice and study arise from _____. Teach others to the best of your ability, even if it is only a single sentence or phrase." Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
52. What are three basic elements of applying the practice of Nichiren Daishonin's Buddhism?
A Faith, Practice, Study **B** Meditation, Introspection, Dedication
C Altruism, Environmentally conscious, Frugalism **D** Contentment, Worship, Self-Absorption
53. _____ means belief in the Buddhism of Nichiren Daishonin – the correct teaching for the Latter Day of the Law – and in the Gohonzon, its ultimate expression. Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
54. _____ refers to concrete effort to transform and develop our lives. Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
55. _____ means learning and inquiring into the teachings of Nichiren Buddhism. Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
56. In the Lotus Sutra, a passage addressed to Shariputra, who was known as the foremost in wisdom among Shakyamuni's disciples, reads: "Even you, Shariputra, in the case of this sutra were able to gain entrance through _____ alone." Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
57. Only through _____ can we attain the same great wisdom and life state as the Buddha. Fill in the blank.
A Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
58. Practice has two aspects:
A Practice for legacy and practice for deceased **B** Practice for oneself and practice for others
C To gain status and wealth **D** Fame and fortune
59. _____ means striving to gain personal benefits from practicing Nichiren Buddhism. Fill in the blank.
A Practice for legacy **B** Practice for deceased **C** Practice for oneself **D** Practice for others
60. _____ means teachings Buddhism to others so that they may also receive benefit. Fill in the blank.
A Practice for legacy **B** Practice for deceased **C** Practice for oneself **D** Practice for others
61. Specifically, practice for ourselves means:
A Reading all 28 volumes of the Lotus Sutra **B** Reading the Mahayana Sutras
C Giving up secular life and taking up tonsure in a monastery **D** Doing gongyo and chanting Nam-myoho-renge-kyo
62. What constitutes practice for others?
A Spreading the teachings of Buddhism **B** Carrying out various activities as SGI members **C** All the above for the sake of Kosen-rufu
D None of the above
63. _____ refers to reciting portions of the Lotus Sutra and chanting Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo before the Gohonzon. Fill in the blank.
A Gosho **B** Gongyo **C** Jugyo **D** Honin-myō

64. Daishonin writes, "A mind now clouded by the illusions of the innate darkness of life is like a tarnished mirror, but when polished, it is sure to become like a clear mirror, reflecting the essential nature of phenomena and the true aspect of reality. Arouse deep faith, and diligently polish your mirror day and night. How should you polish it? Only by chanting _____. " Fill in the blank.
- A** Nam-myoho-renge-kyo **B** Sadda-dharma-pundarika-sutra **C** Namu-Amida-butsu
D Om-Ganapataye-Namah
65. Chanting Nam-myoho-renge-kyo with faith in the Gohonzon is called:
- A** Primary practice **B** Supporting practice **C** Tertiary practice **D** Diligent practice
66. Reciting the "Expedient Means" and "Life Span" chapters of the Lotus Sutra is called:
- A** Primary practice **B** Supporting practice **C** Tertiary practice **D** Diligent practice
67. The most important chapter of the Lotus Sutra which opens the way to enlightenment for all people is:
- A** Expedient Means **B** Life Span **C** Both **D** None
68. How do we avoid the risk of lapsing into our own personal interpretations of Buddhism and being easily deceived by those presenting erroneous teachings?
- A** Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
69. President Toda said, "Faith seeks understanding, and understanding deepens _____. " Fill in the blank.
- A** Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation
70. The purpose of studying and deepening our understanding of Buddhism is to deepen our _____. Fill in the blank.
- A** Faith **B** Practice **C** Study **D** Meditation

Mock Paper 3

39 questions · Faith for Overcoming Obstacles · Changing One's Karma · Faith Equals Daily Life

FAITH FOR OVERCOMING OBSTACLES

1. The hindrances that arise as we practice Buddhism are called:
A Three Obstacles and Four Devils **B** Three Powerful Enemies **C** Both **D** None
2. "As practice progresses and understanding grows, _____ emerge in confusing form, vying with one another to interfere... One should be neither influenced nor frightened by them." Fill in the blank.
A Three Obstacles and Four Devils **B** Three Powerful Enemies **C** Ten troops **D** Ten Demon daughters
3. 'The three obstacles' that hinder us in our faith and practice are:
A The obstacle of earthly desires, the obstacle of karma and the obstacle of retribution **B** The hindrance of five components, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king
C The obstacle of karma, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king **D** The hindrance of earthly desires, hindrance of five components, hindrance of death
4. _____ indicates impulses or afflictions such as greed, anger and foolishness preventing us from progressing in Buddhist faith and practice. Fill in the blank.
A The obstacle of earthly desires **B** The obstacle of karma **C** The obstacle of retribution
D The hindrance of earthly desires
5. _____ refers to hindrances to our faith and practice that result from our evil acts in this life. For e.g. opposition from those close to us such as one's spouse or children. Fill in the blank.
A The obstacle of earthly desires **B** The obstacle of karma **C** The obstacle of retribution
D The hindrance of earthly desires
6. _____ describes impediments to our Buddhist practice that are due to difficult circumstances into which we are born or have come to live. These are considered adverse rewards or reckoning that stem from bad karma formed in the past lifetimes. The Daishonin associates these with opposition coming from people whose wishes one is bound to follow such as the sovereign of one's nation and one's parents. Fill in the blank.
A The obstacle of earthly desires **B** The obstacle of karma **C** The obstacle of retribution
D The hindrance of earthly desires
7. 'Four Devils' are:
A The obstacle of earthly desires, the obstacle of death, the obstacle of karma and the obstacle of retribution **B** The hindrance of five components, the hindrance of earthly desires, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king
C The obstacle of karma, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king and the hindrance of five components **D** The hindrance of retribution, hindrance of five components, hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king
8. _____ arises from disharmony among the workings of the body and mind of those who carry out faith and practice. Fill in the blank.
A The hindrance of the five components **B** The hindrance of earthly desires **C** The hindrance of death
D The hindrance of the devil king

9. _____ means the emergence within one's life of afflictions such as greed, anger and foolishness that function to destroy one's faith. Fill in the blank.
- A The hindrance of the five components B The hindrance of earthly desires C The hindrance of death
D The hindrance of the devil king
10. _____ comes when a person's Buddhist practice is cut short due to his or her death. Also when the death of another practitioner or of anyone close, causes one to doubt one's Buddhist faith. Fill in the blank.
- A The hindrance of the five components B The hindrance of earthly desires C The hindrance of death
D The hindrance of the devil king
11. _____ emerges from fundamental delusion innate in life itself. It reveals itself in different forms and utilizes various means to persecute and oppress those who are practicing Buddhism correctly. Most typically, it appears in the lives of those in power or who have a strong influence over practitioners. Fill in the blank.
- A The hindrance of the five components B The hindrance of earthly desires C The hindrance of death
D The hindrance of the devil king
12. Who makes free use of the fruits of others' efforts for his own pleasure?
- A Devil King of Sixth Heaven B Wheel Turning King C Heavenly King Vaishravana
D King Wonderful Adornment
13. "Something uncommon also occurs when an ordinary person attains Buddhahood. At such a time, _____ will invariably appear and the wise will rejoice while the foolish will retreat." Fill in the blank.
- A Three Obstacles and Four Devils B Three Powerful Enemies C Ten troops D Ten Demon daughters
14. 'Three powerful enemies' are:
- A The obstacle of earthly desires, the obstacle of death, the obstacle of karma and the obstacle of retribution B The hindrance of five components, the hindrance of earthly desires, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king
C The obstacle of karma, the hindrance of death, the hindrance of the devil king and the hindrance of five components D Arrogant lay people, arrogant monks and arrogant false sages
15. _____ are those ignorant of Buddhism who persecute practitioners of the Lotus Sutra. The Sutra explains that they will subject the Sutra's practitioners to slander, cursing and speaking ill of them or even attacking them with weapons such as swords and staves. Fill in the blank.
- A Arrogant lay people B Arrogant monks C Arrogant false sages D Arrogant politicians
16. _____ are Buddhist clergy who slander the Lotus Sutra's practitioners. Because their understanding is flawed and their hearts crooked, they fail to understand the truth of the Buddhist teachings. And yet, attached to their own ways of thinking and believing themselves superior to others, they harass and persecute those who uphold the correct teaching. Fill in the blank.
- A Arrogant lay people B Arrogant monks C Arrogant false sages D Arrogant politicians
17. _____ are seemingly respectable monks or priests whom people regard as sages. Typically they reside in places removed from society. Consumed by greed and the desire for profit, they harbour ill will and contrive to undermine or deceive practitioners of the Lotus Sutra. Their usual tactic is to approach the ruler, senior officials, or others in authority and make false claims about practitioners, such as declaring them to be persons of mistaken views, in an attempt to motivate those in power to oppress them. Fill in the blank.
- A Arrogant lay people B Arrogant monks C Arrogant false sages D Arrogant politicians

CHANGING ONE'S KARMA

18. The term 'karma' originates from the Sanskrit word meaning:

- A** Action **B** Causes **C** Effects **D** Thoughts

19. By believing in the Gohonzon and striving to chant Nam-myoho-renge-kyo for our own and other's happiness, we bring the sun of Buddhahood to rise within our lives, causing _____ from our many past lifetimes to vanish like frost or dew in the sunlight. Fill in the blank.

- A** the negative karma **B** the positive karma **C** the neutral karma **D** the light karma

20. Nichiren Daishonin teaches that encountering hardships and being able thereby to change our karma is actually a benefit of Buddhist practice called:

- A** Acquiring the Buddha eye **B** Lessening one's karmic retribution
C Displaying the 32 featured Buddha characteristics **D** Opening the Alaya-consciousness

21. Heavy karma accruing from serious offences in previous lifetimes will bring about major suffering, not only in the present life but future lifetimes as well. The beneficial power of our Buddhist practice, however – of believing in and striving to spread the correct teaching – enables us to receive the effects of such offences in this single lifetime, and in a much-diminished form. This principle is called:

- A** Acquiring the Buddha eye **B** Lessening one's karmic retribution
C Displaying the 32 featured Buddha characteristics **D** Opening the Alaya-consciousness

22. The Daishonin writes, "Iron, when heated in the flames and pounded becomes a fine sword. Worthies and sages are tested by abuse. My present exile is not because of any secular crime. It is solely so that I may expiate in this lifetime my _____ and freed in the next from the three evil paths." Fill in the blank.

- A** Minor crimes **B** Secular offences **C** Past grave offences **D** Future causes

23. "What we had previously viewed as destiny, we come to see as _____. There is absolutely no way we cannot overcome sufferings." Fill in the blank.

- A** Suffering **B** Legacy **C** Past offences **D** Mission

24. The Lotus sutra teaches that bodhisattvas who accumulated great good fortune through their Buddhist practice in past lives voluntarily relinquish the rewards due to them for their pure deeds and choose instead to be born into this impure world that is filled with evil. They do so because they feel compassion for living beings and wish to save them from suffering. This principle is called:

- A** Lessening karmic retribution **B** Voluntarily assuming appropriate karma
C Mutual possession of ten worlds **D** Earthly desires are enlightenment

FAITH EQUALS DAILY LIFE

25. The Daishonin states, "Believe in this mandala with all your heart. _____ is like the roar of a lion. What sickness can therefore be an obstacle?" Fill in the blank.

- A** Nam-myoho-renge-kyo **B** Gongyo **C** Gohonzon **D** Gosho

26. Through the power of chanting Nam-myoho-renge-kyo, we will also be protected by:

- A** Heavenly gods **B** Benevolent deities **C** All the above **D** None of the above

27. "Those who now believe in the Lotus sutra will gather _____ from ten thousand miles away." Fill in the blank.

- A** Fortune **B** Courage **C** Compassion **D** Wisdom

28. _____ refers to the various workings or functions that serve to protect a person who practices the correct Buddhist teaching. Fill in the blank.
- A Heavenly gods & Benevolent deities B Demon Children C Ten troops D Three treasures
29. The Daishonin states, "The protection of the gods depends on the strength of one's _____. Fill in the blank.
- A Faith B Practice C Study D Meditation
30. The most essential principle and guideline for forming unity based on faith for the purpose of advancing kosen-rufu, is called:
- A One in body, many in mind B Many in Body, one in mind C One in body, one in mind
D Many in body, many in mind
31. _____ means that our appearance, nature, qualities and talents, social position, and circumstances differ from one another. Fill in the blank.
- A Many in mind B One in Body C Many in Body D One in Mind
32. _____ means that we share the same intention and purpose. Fill in the blank.
- A Many in mind B One in Body C Many in Body D One in Mind
33. The mind in 'one in mind' indicates faith, and 'one in mind' means to join our hearts and minds in sharing the great wish and vow to:
- A achieve kosen-rufu B reach self-enlightenment C reach Brahma heaven D reach Pure land of bliss
34. While each of us gives free and full play to our individuality and distinctive qualities, displaying our unique potential to the highest degree, we aim together for the lofty goal of kosen-rufu. This is the meaning of:
- A One in body, many in mind B Many in Body, one in mind C One in body, one in mind
D Many in body, many in mind
35. The Daishonin says, "If the spirit of _____ prevails among the people, they will achieve all their goals, whereas if one in body but different in mind, they can achieve nothing remarkable... In contrast, although Nichiren and his followers are few, because they are different in body, but united in mind, they will definitely accomplish their great mission of widely propagating the Lotus Sutra." Fill in the blank.
- A One in body, many in mind B Many in Body, one in mind C One in body, one in mind
D Many in body, many in mind
36. The principle that explains that one's daily life is an expression of one's Buddhist faith is:
- A Lessening karmic retribution B Voluntarily assuming appropriate karma
C Mutual possession of ten worlds D Faith equals daily life
37. The Daishonin states, "The purpose of the appearance in this world of Shakyamuni Buddha, the lord of teachings, lies in _____. Fill in the blank.
- A His behaviour as a supreme being B His behaviour as a heavenly being
C His behaviour as a human being D His behaviour as an insentient being
38. The noblest kind of human behaviour is that which demonstrates _____. Fill in the blank.
- A Respect for rules B Respect to elders C Respect for all people D Respect to traditions
39. The Lotus Sutra describes the practice of _____ which consists of respecting the potential for Buddhahood inherent in all people and for that reason venerating every person he meets. Fill in the blank.
- A Bodhisattva Medicine King B Bodhisattva Never Disparaging C Bodhisattva Universal Worthy
D Bodhisattva Wonderful sound

Mock Paper 4

61 questions · The History of the Soka Gakkai · Repudiating the Nichiren Shoshu Priesthood under Nikken · Goshō Passages

THE HISTORY OF THE SOKA GAKKAI

- The Soka Gakkai's first three presidents are in the correct order:
A Tsunesaburo Makiguchi, Daisaku Ikeda, Josei Toda **B** Josei Toda, Tsunesaburo Makiguchi, Daisaku Ikeda
C Daisaku Ikeda, Josei Toda, Tsunesaburo Makiguchi **D** Tsunesaburo Makiguchi, Josei Toda, Daisaku Ikeda
- The first president, Tsunesaburo Makiguchi and second president Josei Toda were both:
A Lawyers **B** Bankers **C** Educators **D** Businessmen
- Makiguchi sensei's hope and vow was to enable every child to succeed in creating personal happiness as a self-sufficient member of society. He developed an approach to education which he systematized to serve as a foundation for his unique pedagogy based on:
A Theory of money **B** Theory of value **C** Theory of goods **D** Theory of returns
- The day Makiguchi sensei published his first volume of Soka Kyoikugaku Taikei (The System of Value-Creating Pedagogy) is celebrated as the day of Soka Gakkai's founding. What is the date:
A Nov 1, 1928 **B** Nov 18, 1928 **C** Nov 18, 1930 **D** Nov 18, 1932
- Soka means:
A Creation of wealth **B** Creation of good fortune **C** Creation of happiness **D** Creation of value
- The concept of the word Soka itself came about in the course of a discussion between the two innovative educators. We could say the birth of Soka Gakkai was itself a crystalization of the united spirit of:
A Mentor and disciple **B** Business partners **C** Co-educators **D** Co-counsel
- Makiguchi sensei encountered the Buddhism of Nichiren Daishonin which he realized clarified the principles and fundamental practice for enabling the kind of life transformation that would give rise to value creation in human society. How old was he at that time?
A 57 years old **B** 55 years old **C** 45 years old **D** 32 years old
- How did the Soka Kyoiku Gakkai uphold the Daishonin's teachings and strictly admonish slander of the law?
A Refusing to accept the Shinto Talisman **B** By accepting the Nichiren Shoshu high priest
C By joining the war efforts **D** By worshipping the Sun Goddess
- On which day were Makiguchi, Toda and 21 other leaders of Soka Kyoiku Gakkai arrested by detectives of Special Higher police for suspicion of committing lese majesty (the crime of violating the dignity of the Emperor) and violating the Peace Preservation Law?
A June 6 **B** July 6 **C** August 6 **D** September 6
- Makiguchi sensei passed away at the Tokyo detention centre due to malnutrition and weakness of old age at 73. What date was it?
A Nov 18, 1945 **B** Nov 18, 1944 **C** Nov 18, 1943 **D** Nov 18, 1942
- While in prison, Toda sensei while exerting himself in chanting daimoku also began to read the Lotus Sutra and ponder it deeply. He awakened to the realization that:
A "life is impermanent" **B** "There is a pure land that exists" **C** "Saha world is the world of hell"
D "Buddha is life itself"

12. In Nov 1944, Toda awakened to the deep conviction that “_____” whose mission it was to accomplish kosen-rufu. The awakening Toda experienced in prison become the primary inspiration behind the revival of Buddhism in the modern age and the powerful progress of the Soka Gakkai as a religious group dedicated to the accomplishment of kosen-rufu. Fill in the blank.

- A “I have the power” B “I’m invincible” C “I’m a supreme god” D “I, am a Bodhisattva of the Earth”

13. When did Toda emerge from prison to carry on the will of his mentor Makiguchi by immediately undertaking the reconstruction of the organization?

- A June 3, 1945 B July 3, 1945 C Aug 3, 1945 D Sep 3, 1945

14. The organization’s goal would be not only to carry out educational reform, but to accomplish kosen-rufu, that is, peace throughout the world and happiness for all people. In line with this purpose he amended the name to:

- A Soka Kyoiku Teikei B Soka Gakkai C Nichiren Shoshu D Nikken Sect

15. When did Ikeda join Soka Gakkai? He was 19 years old at the time when he met a 47 year old Toda and decided to make him his lifelong mentor.

- A Aug 14, 1947 B Aug 15, 1947 C Aug 24, 1947 D Aug 24, 1948

16. When Ikeda decided to stop attending night school so that he could fully support his mentor, Toda sensei told him he would personally instruct him and provide him with a broad education surpassing any he would obtain from a university. These private instructions continued a decade until the year of Toda’s death and he called them:

- A Soka Education B Value Creating University C Toda University D Makiguchi University

17. Toda sensei discussed his vision for the future with his most trusted disciple. As a result of such dialogues between mentor and disciple what institutions were established:

- A Seikyo Shumbun – organization newspaper B Founding of Soka University C Both of the above
D None of the above

18. Toda sensei was inaugurated as the second president on May 3, 1951. On that occasion, he made what declaration:

- A Soka Gakkai is the king of the religious world B A vow to achieve a membership of 750,000 households
C Youth are his true successors D His successor Daisaku will spread the teachings outside Japan

19. _____ refers to the process by which through the practice of Nichiren Buddhism, each individual achieves a transformation of their state of life, eventually leading to a transformation in the destiny of all humankind. Fill in the blank.

- A Human Revolution B Religious Revolution C Spiritual revolution D Social Revolution

20. In April 1952, Toda sensei marked the 700th observation of the Daishonin’s establishment of his teaching with what accomplishment?

- A Publishing the Goshō Zenshu (Collected writings of Nichiren Daishonin) B Publishing the Seikyo Shimbun
C Opening Soka School D Erecting the Shō Hondo at Taisei-ji temple

21. In 1956, in Kansai, Ikeda inspired a remarkable increase in propagation, and in May the Osaka Chapter achieved an unprecedented membership in just one month of:

- A 201 households B 111 households C 11,111 households D 111,111 households

22. In June 1957, coal miners union in Hokkaido, acted unjustly to suppress Soka Gakkai members' religious freedom. This became known as:
- A Hokkaido Coal Union Incident B Yubai Coal Miners Union Incident C Osaka Incident
D Operation 'C'
23. On July 3, 1957, immediately after leaving Yubai, Ikeda was unjustly arrested by the Osaka Prefectural Police in what became known as:
- A Yubai Coal Miners Union Incident B Osaka Incident C Operation 'C' D Priesthood Issue
24. When did Toda sensei deliver his "Declaration for the Abolition of Nuclear Weapons" which would become the start and keynote of the Soka Gakkai's peace movement?
- A Sep 8, 1957 B Aug 24, 1950 C Mar 16, 1957 D Apr 2, 1958
25. March 16 is the day on which young successors were entrusted with the great wish and vow for kosen-rufu and came to be called as:
- A Soka Mother's Day B Soka Successor's Day C Kosen-rufu Day D Soka Gakkai Founding Day
26. Toda sensei passed away, having completed all he had set out to accomplish. He was 58. What date was it?
- A Apr 2, 1958 B Mar 16, 1957 C Aug 24, 1951 D Sep 8, 1957
27. When was Daisaku Ikeda inaugurated as the third president of Soka Gakkai?
- A May 3, 1958 B May 3, 1959 C May 3, 1960 D May 3, 1961
28. What was significant about the day 2 October, 1960?
- A Ikeda took on the leadership of Soka Gakkai as its third president B Ikeda took the first step in a journey towards Worldwide Kosen-rufu
C Ikeda remonstrated with the coal miners union D Ikeda was imprisoned by the Osaka Prefectural police on false charges
29. In 1965, under the pen name of Ho Goku he began writing the novel The Human Revolution which portrays the efforts and struggles of the three founding presidents of Soka Gakkai with the main theme: 'A great _____ in just a single individual will help achieve a change in the destiny of a nation and further, will enable a change in the destiny of all humankind.' Fill in the blank.
- A Human revolution B Knowledge transfer C Contemplative wisdom D Selfless action
30. Ikeda sensei chronicled the Soka Gakkai's history in a 30-volume novel also serialized in the Seikyo Shimbun newspaper called:
- A The Human Revolution B The New Human Revolution C Soka Education D Soka Revolution
31. On _____, Soka Gakkai members representing 51 countries and territories gathered on the Pacific Island of Guam for the establishment of the Soka Gakkai International (SGI), appointing Ikeda sensei as its president. Fill in the blank.
- A Jan 2, 1928 B Jan 26, 1975 C Jan 1, 1930 D Jan 25, 1950
32. Beginning in 1983, Ikeda sensei has issued a _____ every year on January 26, in commemoration of SGI Day. Fill in the blank.
- A Peace Treaties B Peace Proposals C UN Declarations D SGI Proclamations
33. In Nov 2013, a new edifice was completed in Shinanomachi Tokyo, as part of the Soka Gakkai Headquarters complex, called:
- A The Hall of the Great Vow for Kosen-rufu B The Sho Hondo C The Grand Reception Hall
D The Seikyo Shimbun Building

34. In his dedication on the monument displayed in the entrance of the Hall of the Great Vow, Ikeda sensei wrote, “_____ is the path of attaining universal peace and prosperity. It is our great vow from time without beginning for the enlightenment of all people.” Fill in the blank.

- A** Human Revolution **B** Kosen-Rufu **C** Many in Body, One in Mind **D** Itai-Doshin

35. The inscription on the Soka Gakkai Gohonzon reads: “For the fulfillment of the great vow for kosen-rufu through _____.” Fill in the blank.

- A** the compassionate propagation of the Great law” **B** the conversion of all humankind to Buddhism”
C the denouncement of all false religions.” **D** The refutation of other Buddhist schools.”

REPUDIATING THE NICHIREN SHOSHU PRIESTHOOD UNDER NIKKEN

36. What refers to the priesthood of the Nichiren Shoshu Buddhist school in its corrupt state under the leadership of the 67th high priest, whose position is that the high priest possesses absolute and uncontested authority and power:

- A** Nembutsu Believers **B** True World Scholars **C** Nikken Sect **D** Zen Buddhists

37. Nichiren Daishonin writes, “Rather than offering up ten thousand prayers for remedy, it would be better simply to _____.” Fill in the blank.

- A** Embrace the high priest **B** Outlaw this one evil **C** Ban the corrupt priests **D** Forgive the evil doers

38. Daishonin writes, “However great the good causes one may make... if one fails to denounce _____, it will be impossible to attain the way.” Fill in the blank.

- A** The enemies of the Lotus Sutra **B** The enemies of the Buddha **C** The enemies of the Nirvana Sutra
D The enemies of the Nichiren Shoshu

39. By scheming to destroy the Soka Gakkai, the organization working to accomplish the Daishonin’s will of kosen-rufu, it is _____ who accords with the definition of an enemy of the Lotus Sutra. Fill in the blank.

- A** Nichikan **B** Nissho **C** Nikken **D** Nichimoku

40. “To attain Buddhahood, we have to thoroughly conquer our own _____. Struggling to defeat evil enables us to polish and purify our lives and attain Buddhahood.” Fill in the blank.

- A** Inner desire **B** Inner eye **C** Inner ego **D** Inner evil

41. Nikken’s aim was to sever relations with the Soka Gakkai and take control of its members, turning them into subservient followers of the priests, and in 1990 he conceived and put into action a surreptitious plan he named:

- A** Operation K **B** Operation C **C** Operation B **D** Operation Z

42. The Soka Gakkai sought to address and resolve the situation through dialogue, but the priesthood refused any discussion. They first sent a document titled “remonstrance to disband” followed on _____ by a “Notice of Excommunication.” Fill in the blank.

- A** 28 Nov 1991 **B** 7 Nov 1991 **C** 18 Nov 1990 **D** 18 Nov 1992

43. The priesthood was holding _____, the basis of faith, hostage in a cowardly attempt to pressure and intimidate believers. Fill in the blank.

- A** Gosho **B** Gohonzon **C** Juju beads **D** Liturgy book

44. A careful study of the essential principles of Nichiren Buddhism makes clear key errors of the Nikken sect:

- A** Slander of destroying kosen-rufu **B** The grave offense of causing disunity in the Buddhist order
C The false doctrine of worship of high priest **D** All of the above

45. In 'The twenty-six admonitions of Nikko,' he writes, "Do not follow even the _____ if he goes against the Buddha's Law and propounds his own views." Fill in the blank.
- A High priest B Honourable laity C Lay believers D Young priests
46. "Heritage" or "lineage" in Nichiren Buddhism has always been something open to all people, not the exclusive possession of an elite few. However, Nikken and his followers hold an erroneous view of heritage which is the source of their notion that the high priest is absolute. The idea of the existence of a _____ that is passed on from one high priest to the next is false. By receiving the lineage, one exclusively inherits the Buddha's enlightenment and the essence of the Buddha's Law. Fill in the blank.
- A Mysterious transmission B Secret documents C Supernatural powers D Special ornaments
47. The harmful tendencies and errors inherent in the temple parishioner system remain deeply ingrained in the Nikken sect, and this has resulted in a belief that the priests are _____ to the laity. Fill in the blank.
- A Inferior B At par C Superior D Slaves
48. One of the major errors of the Nikken sect is its misuse of Buddhist rituals and ceremonies, turning them into means for making money. These include:
- A Funeral and memorial services B Bestowal of posthumous Buddhist names
C Issuing of wooden memorial tablets to be placed D All of the above
beside the grave
49. With regard to the conduct of priests, Nichiren Daishonin states "True priests are those who are honest and who desire little and yet know satisfaction." The priests of Nikken sect, however, beginning with Nikken himself have consistently behaved in a corrupt and self-indulgent manner. The Daishonin compared any such irresponsible priest who uses Buddhism for selfish gain to:
- A 'An animal dressed in priestly robes' B 'Law-devouring hungry spirits' C All of the above
D None of the above
50. For Soka Gakkai members, which is the day that marked their Spiritual independence, freeing themselves from the chains of the corrupt and misguided priesthood?
- A Nov 1, 1992 B Nov 28, 1991 C Nov 28, 1992 D Nov 7, 1991

GOSHO PASSAGES

51. In the Gosho, The Real Aspect of the Gohonzon, Daishonin writes, "This Gohonzon also is found only in the two characters of _____. This is what the Lotus Sutra means when it states that one can 'gain entrance through faith alone'" Fill in the blank.
- A Faith B Study C Practice D Meditation
52. In the letter, "The Real Aspect of the Gohonzon," the Daishonin calls the Gohonzon, the object of devotion as:
- A "The banner of propagation of the Lotus Sutra" B "the great mandala never before known"
C "a cluster of blessings" D All of the above
53. Even Shariputra, one of Shakyamuni's 10 major disciples, who was hailed as 'Foremost in Wisdom,' was only able to enter the boundless realm of Buddhahood through _____, not through wisdom. Fill in the blank.
- A Courage B Compassion C Faith D Life force

54. "A mind now clouded by the illusions of the innate darkness of life is like a tarnished mirror, but when polished it is sure to become like a clear mirror, reflecting the essential nature of phenomena and the true aspect of reality. Arouse deep faith and polish your mirror day and night. How should you polish it? Only by _____." Fill in the blank.

- A** Chanting Nam-Amida-Butsu **B** Performing meritorious deeds in lifetime after lifetime
C Chanting Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo **D** Reciting all 28 chapters of the Lotus Sutra

55. Nichiren Buddhism underscores the importance of transforming our own minds, our fundamental mindset. Generally, people tend to think there is a huge divide between ordinary people and Buddhas. But the Daishonin taught that there is no such gap – the only difference is that of being _____ and being _____. Fill in both blanks.

- A** Radiant, dormant **B** Deluded, Awakened **C** Excited, dejected **D** Liar, honest

56. Chanting Nam-myoho-enge-kyo is the means to:

- A** Transforming a deluded state into an enlightened one **B** Acquire wealth without making efforts
C Magically teleport to the pure land of bliss **D** Bring harm to those who make us unjustly suffer

57. A tarnished mirror represents:

- A** Fundamental darkness **B** Enlightenment **C** Split personalities **D** Dharma Body

58. A clear mirror represents:

- A** A life awakened to the truth of reality **B** Fundamental darkness **C** Ignorance **D** Maya

59. "Exert yourself in the two ways of _____ and _____." Fill in both blanks.

- A** Faith, study **B** Practice, Faith **C** Study, faith **D** Practice, study

60. "You must not only persevere yourself; you must also teach others. Both practice and study arise from faith. Teach others to the best of your ability, even if it is only _____ or _____." Fill in both blanks.

- A** A poem, verse **B** A single sentence, phrase **C** A stanza, a line. **D** A haiku, sonnet.

61. Study based on the mentor-disciple spirit is the Soka Gakkai tradition. It is study for:

- A** Winning, providing us with the foundation to overcome obstacles **B** Sharing the Mystic Law and realizing kosen-rufu
C Inner transformation and human revolution **D** All of the above

Exam-Condition Paper A

40 questions drawn across all twelve topics · one hour · the same shape as the real paper

1. "If you care anything about your personal security, you should first of all pray for order and tranquility throughout _____, should you not?"
A The four quarters of the land **B** The three quarters of the land **C** The two quarters of the land
D The one quarter of the land
2. The Daishonin writes, "In judging the relative merit of Buddhist doctrines, I, Nichiren, believe that the best standards are those of reason and documentary proof. And even more valuable than reason and documentary proof is the proof of _____." Fill in the Blank.
A Actual Fact **B** Errors **C** Inconsistencies **D** Missing fractions
3. In Nov 2013, a new edifice was completed in Shinanomachi Tokyo, as part of the Soka Gakkai Headquarters complex, called:
A The Hall of the Great Vow for Kosen-rufu **B** The Sho Hondo **C** The Grand Reception Hall
D The Seikyo Shimbun Building
4. One of the major errors of the Nikken sect is its misuse of Buddhist rituals and ceremonies, turning them into means for making money. These include:
A Funeral and memorial services **B** Bestowal of posthumous Buddhist names
C Issuing of wooden memorial tablets to be placed **D** All of the above
beside the grave
5. While each of us gives free and full play to our individuality and distinctive qualities, displaying our unique potential to the highest degree, we aim together for the lofty goal of kosen-rufu. This is the meaning of:
A One in body, many in mind **B** Many in Body, one in mind **C** One in body, one in mind
D Many in body, many in mind
6. Nam stands for the Sanskrit term "Namu" meaning:
A To devote one's life **B** To respect others **C** To pay obeisance **D** To fold palms in reverence
7. _____ means that a religion's doctrines are based upon or in accord with its foundational scriptures. Fill in the blank.
A Theoretical Proof **B** Documentary Proof **C** Actual Proof **D** Doctoral Proof
8. "You must not only persevere yourself; you must also teach others. Both practice and study arise from faith. Teach others to the best of your ability, even if it is only _____ or _____. " Fill in both blanks.
A A poem, verse **B** A single sentence, phrase **C** A stanza, a line. **D** A haiku, sonnet.
9. What is the life state in which we experience 'joy' that is not lasting? It fades and disappears with the passage of time.
A Animals **B** Asuras **C** Human Beings **D** Heavenly Beings
10. "If Nichiren's compassion is truly great and encompassing, Nam-myoho-renge-kyo will spread for...":
A One thousand years **B** Two thousand years **C** Five thousand years
D Ten thousand years and more, for all eternity
11. In June 1957, coal miners union in Hokkaido, acted unjustly to suppress Soka Gakkai members' religious freedom. This became known as:
A Hokkaido Coal Union Incident **B** Yubai Coal Miners Union Incident **C** Osaka Incident
D Operation 'C'

12. The term 'karma' originates from the Sanskrit word meaning:
A Action B Causes C Effects D Thoughts
13. On May 12 1261, Daishonin was arrested and sentenced to exile in Ito. This is called:
A Sado Exile B Izu Exile C Kyoto Exile D Minobu Exile
14. President Toda said, "Faith seeks understanding, and understanding deepens _____. " Fill in the blank.
A Faith B Practice C Study D Meditation
15. It is _____ that has made the predictions of Shakyamuni and Nichiren Daishonin of making Kosen-rufu a reality.
A True World School B Zen School C Tendai School D Soka Gakkai
16. He proclaimed Nam-myoho-Renge Kyo to be the sole teaching for leading all people in the Latter Day of the Law on
A 28 Apr 1253 B 16 Aug 1222 C 1 Apr 1268 D 16 Feb 1279
17. The Daishonin identifies the profound connection between the life state of Buddhahood and faith in the Mystic Law, saying, "The ordinary people born in the latter age can believe in the Lotus Sutra is due to the fact that the world of _____ is present in the human world." Fill in the blank.
A Learning B Realisation C Bodhisattva D Buddhahood
18. The mind in 'one in mind' indicates faith, and 'one in mind' means to join our hearts and minds in sharing the great wish and vow to:
A achieve kosen-rufu B reach self-enlightenment C reach Brahma heaven D reach Pure land of bliss
19. The Daishonin passed away at Ikegami Munenaka's residence on 13 Oct, 1282 at the age of 61. After his death, only one of his disciples carried out his mentor's fearless spirit and actions for kosen-rufu. Who was his successor:
A Nikko Shonin B Nanjo Tokimitsu C Ikegami Munenaka D Lay Nun Sennichi
20. Which is the life state where one is obsessed with personal superiority or self-importance, a tendency to always compare oneself with others and want to be better than them?
A Hell B Hunger C Animality D Anger
21. "...always to advance from the state of suffering to the state of _____, and then to proceed from that state to transform reality" Fill in the blank.
A Tranquillity B Rapture C Buddhahood D Cause Awakened Ones
22. Soka means:
A Creation of wealth B Creation of good fortune C Creation of happiness D Creation of value
23. _____ arises from disharmony among the workings of the body and mind of those who carry out faith and practice. Fill in the blank.
A The hindrance of the five components B The hindrance of earthly desires C The hindrance of death D The hindrance of the devil king
24. "Perversity" means concealing one's true feelings in order to ingratiate oneself with others. There are two aspects to this perversity. One is to fawn and deceive. What is the other?
A To feel anguish B To crave what others have C To distort reason D To kill or be killed
25. Nichiren Daishonin depicted his own Buddhahood or enlightened state in the form of ____
A Mandala B Sutra C Talisman D Treatise

26. Chanting Nam-myoho-renge-kyo with faith in the Gohonzon is called:
A Primary practice **B** Supporting practice **C** Tertiary practice **D** Diligent practice
27. The hindrances that arise as we practice Buddhism are called:
A Three Obstacles and Four Devils **B** Three Powerful Enemies **C** Both **D** None
28. Toda sensei was inaugurated as the second president on May 3, 1951. On that occasion, he made what declaration:
A Soka Gakkai is the king of the religious world **B** A vow to achieve a membership of 750,000 households
C Youth are his true successors **D** His successor Daisaku will spread the teachings outside Japan
29. "Exert yourself in the two ways of _____ and _____." Fill in both blanks.
A Faith, study **B** Practice, Faith **C** Study, faith **D** Practice, study
30. The Daishonin writes, "Iron, when heated in the flames and pounded becomes a fine sword. Worthies and sages are tested by abuse. My present exile is not because of any secular crime. It is solely so that I may expiate in this lifetime my _____ and freed in the next from the three evil paths." Fill in the blank.
A Minor crimes **B** Secular offences **C** Past grave offences **D** Future causes
31. Reciting the "Expedient Means" and "Life Span" chapters of the Lotus Sutra is called:
A Primary practice **B** Supporting practice **C** Tertiary practice **D** Diligent practice
32. The concept of the word Soka itself came about in the course of a discussion between the two innovative educators. We could say the birth of Soka Gakkai was itself a crystallization of the united spirit of:
A Mentor and disciple **B** Business partners **C** Co-educators **D** Co-counsel
33. Person in the two worlds of learning and realization are together referred to as:
A Persons of the one vehicle **B** Persons of the two vehicles **C** Persons of the three vehicles
D Persons of the four vehicles
34. Attaining Buddhahood is the process of manifesting the life state of a Buddha which is originally present within all people. This is called:
A Attaining Buddhahood in one's present form **B** To be reborn in the pure land
C To become a superior human being **D** To become an extraordinary person
35. Nichiren Daishonin teaches that encountering hardships and being able thereby to change our karma is actually a benefit of Buddhist practice called:
A Acquiring the Buddha eye **B** Lessening one's karmic retribution
C Displaying the 32 featured Buddha characteristics **D** Opening the Alaya-consciousness
36. He confirmed that _____ was the foremost among all the Buddhist sutras
A Nirvana Sutra **B** Agama Sutra **C** Lotus Sutra **D** Immeasurable Meanings Sutra
37. The Soka Gakkai sought to address and resolve the situation through dialogue, but the priesthood refused any discussion. They first sent a document titled "remonstrance to disband" followed on _____ by a "Notice of Excommunication." Fill in the blank.
A 28 Nov 1991 **B** 7 Nov 1991 **C** 18 Nov 1990 **D** 18 Nov 1992
38. Which is the life state attained by those who gain a partial awakening through hearing the Buddha's teachings?
A Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Bodhisattvas **D** Buddhas

39. On _____, Soka Gakkai members representing 51 countries and territories gathered on the Pacific Island of Guam for the establishment of the Soka Gakkai International (SGI), appointing Ikeda sensei as its president. Fill in the blank.

- A** Jan 2, 1928 **B** Jan 26, 1975 **C** Jan 1, 1930 **D** Jan 25, 1950

40. _____ comes when a person's Buddhist practice is cut short due to his or her death. Also when the death of another practitioner or of anyone close, causes one to doubt one's Buddhist faith. Fill in the blank.

- A** The hindrance of the five components **B** The hindrance of earthly desires **C** The hindrance of death
D The hindrance of the devil king

Exam-Condition Paper B

40 questions drawn across all twelve topics · one hour · the same shape as the real paper

1. When Ikeda decided to stop attending night school so that he could fully support his mentor, Toda sensei told him he would personally instruct him and provide him with a broad education surpassing any he would obtain from a university. These private instructions continued a decade until the year of Toda's death and he called them:
A Soka Education **B** Value Creating University **C** Toda University **D** Makiguchi University
2. Nichiren Daishonin was born on
A 1 Feb 1222 **B** 16 Feb 1222 **C** 16 Mar 1958 **D** 21 Sep 1278
3. The Daishonin repeatedly urged his followers to dedicate their lives to Kosen-rufu, attain Buddhahood and actualize the principle of:
A On Establishing the correct teachings for the peace of the land **B** Three obstacles and four devils
C Three powerful enemies **D** Three proofs
4. A condition in which material needs are fulfilled and our personal desires satisfied is
A Absolute Happiness **B** Nirvana **C** Supreme Enlightenment **D** Relative Happiness
5. Which world has the limitation of self-centredness where one is self-absorbed seeking only their own enlightenment and making no effort to help others do the same?
A Cause-Awakened Ones **B** Voice-Hearers **C** Both of the above **D** None of the above
6. "To attain Buddhahood, we have to thoroughly conquer our own _____. Struggling to defeat evil enables us to polish and purify our lives and attain Buddhahood." Fill in the blank.
A Inner desire **B** Inner eye **C** Inner ego **D** Inner evil
7. Second Soka Gakkai President Josei Toda described Buddhahood as a state of life in which being alive is itself _____. Fill in the blank.
A Happiness **B** Unhappiness **C** Painful suffering **D** Burdensome
8. A clear mirror represents:
A A life awakened to the truth of reality **B** Fundamental darkness **C** Ignorance **D** Maya
9. When the government rejected his final remonstrance, the Daishonin decided to leave Kamakura and take up residence in:
A Sado Island **B** Kyushu **C** Mount Minobu **D** Mount Hiei
10. The harmful tendencies and errors inherent in the temple parishioner system remain deeply ingrained in the Nikken sect, and this has resulted in a belief that the priests are _____ to the laity. Fill in the blank.
A Inferior **B** At par **C** Superior **D** Slaves
11. The Daishonin says, "If the spirit of _____ prevails among the people, they will achieve all their goals, whereas if one is one in body but different in mind, they can achieve nothing remarkable... In contrast, although Nichiren and his followers are few, because they are different in body, but united in mind, they will definitely accomplish their great mission of widely propagating the Lotus Sutra." Fill in the blank.
A One in body, many in mind **B** Many in body, one in mind **C** One in body, one in mind
D Many in body, many in mind

12. _____ are seemingly respectable monks or priests whom people regard as sages. Typically they reside in places removed from society. Consumed by greed and the desire for profit, they harbour ill will and contrive to undermine or deceive practitioners of the Lotus Sutra. Their usual tactic is to approach the ruler, senior officials, or others in authority and make false claims about practitioners, such as declaring them to be persons of mistaken views, in an attempt to motivate those in power to oppress them. Fill in the blank.

- A Arrogant lay people B Arrogant monks C Arrogant false sages D Arrogant politicians

13. By believing in the Gohonzon and striving to chant Nam-myoho-enge-kyo for our own and other's happiness, we bring the sun of Buddhahood to rise within our lives, causing _____ from our many past lifetimes to vanish like frost or dew in the sunlight. Fill in the blank.

- A the negative karma B the positive karma C the neutral karma D the light karma

14. The Lotus sutra teaches that bodhisattvas who accumulated great good fortune through their Buddhist practice in past lives voluntarily relinquish the rewards due to them for their pure deeds and choose instead to be born into this impure world that is filled with evil. They do so because they feel compassion for living beings and wish to save them from suffering. This principle is called:

- A Lessening karmic retribution B Voluntarily assuming appropriate karma
C Mutual possession of ten worlds D Earthly desires are enlightenment

15. He composed major works like "The Selection of Time" and "On Repaying Debts of Gratitude" in which he elucidates important teachings, in particular, the object of devotion of the essential teaching, the sanctuary of the essential teaching and the daimoku of the essential teaching. These are called:

- A Three Great Secret Laws B Three Kinds of Treasure C Three realms of existence
D Three Bodies of the Buddha

16. Daishonin writes, "A mind now clouded by the illusions of the innate darkness of life is like a tarnished mirror, but when polished, it is sure to become like a clear mirror, reflecting the essential nature of phenomena and the true aspect of reality. Arouse deep faith, and diligently polish your mirror day and night. How should you polish it? Only by chanting _____." Fill in the blank.

- A Nam-myoho-enge-kyo B Sadda-dharma-pundarika-sutra C Namu-Amida-butsu
D Om-Ganapataye-Namah

17. In the Record of the orally transmitted teachings, The Daishonin says, "Great joy [is what] one experiences when one understands for the first time that one's mind from the very beginning has been a Buddha. _____ is the greatest of all joys." Fill in the blank.

- A Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo B Gohonzon C Buddhahood D Faith

18. Which is the state that is a calm, composed state in which people maintain their characteristic human qualities?

- A Animals B Asuras C Human Beings D Heavenly Beings

19. Beginning in 1983, Ikeda sensei has issued a _____ every year on January 26, in commemoration of SGI Day. Fill in the blank.

- A Peace Treaties B Peace Proposals C UN Declarations D SGI Proclamations

20. Daishonin wrote, "Never seek this _____ outside yourself. [It] exists only within the mortal flesh of us ordinary people who embrace the Lotus Sutra and chant Nam-myoho-enge-kyo." Fill in the blank.

- A Buddha B Eternal C Gohonzon D Gosho

21. Study based on the mentor-disciple spirit is the Soka Gakkai tradition. It is study for:

- A Winning, providing us with the foundation to overcome obstacles B Sharing the Mystic Law and realizing kosen-rufu
C Inner transformation and human revolution D All of the above

22. 'Establishing the correct teachings' means:
- A Discarding all other religious symbols and replacing them with statues of Buddha
 - B Making the Buddhist teaching of respect for the dignity of life the motivating principle of society
 - C Erecting the statue of Buddha across all major shrines and supporting high priests
 - D Inviting the Buddhist priests into our homes to enshrine the Dai-Gohonzon
23. _____ means that our appearance, nature, qualities and talents, social position, and circumstances differ from one another. Fill in the blank.
- A Many in mind
 - B One in Body
 - C Many in Body
 - D One in Mind
24. Ikeda sensei chronicled the Soka Gakkai's history in a 30-volume novel also serialized in the Seikyo Shimbun newspaper called:
- A The Human Revolution
 - B The New Human Revolution
 - C Soka Education
 - D Soka Revolution
25. In 1956, in Kansai, Ikeda inspired a remarkable increase in propagation, and in May the Osaka Chapter achieved an unprecedented membership in just one month of:
- A 201 households
 - B 111 households
 - C 11,111 households
 - D 111,111 households
26. _____ refers to concrete effort to transform and develop our lives. Fill in the blank.
- A Faith
 - B Practice
 - C Study
 - D Meditation
27. Absolute Happiness is a state which is:
- A Is not influenced by external conditions
 - B Persists eternally
 - C Both of the above
 - D None of the above
28. The purpose of practicing Nichiren Buddhism, in addition to attaining Buddhahood in this lifetime on an individual level, is to:
- A Establish the sanctuary of the High Priest
 - B Secure happiness of both oneself and others
 - C Create unimaginable wealth for successors
 - D Promote Buddhism as the foremost religion
29. _____ refers to reciting portions of the Lotus Sutra and chanting Nam-Myoho-Renge-Kyo before the Gohonzon. Fill in the blank.
- A Gosho
 - B Gongyo
 - C Jugyo
 - D Honin-myo
30. The Daishonin valued which proof above all other forms of proof?
- A Documentary Proof
 - B Theoretical Proof
 - C Actual Proof
 - D Doctoral Proof
31. _____ refers to the process by which through the practice of Nichiren Buddhism, each individual achieves a transformation of their state of life, eventually leading to a transformation in the destiny of all humankind. Fill in the blank.
- A Human Revolution
 - B Religious Revolution
 - C Spiritual revolution
 - D Social Revolution
32. In 1965, under the pen name of Ho Goku he began writing the novel The Human Revolution which portrays the efforts and struggles of the three founding presidents of Soka Gakkai with the main theme: 'A great _____ in just a single individual will help achieve a change in the destiny of a nation and further, will enable a change in the destiny of all humankind.' Fill in the blank.
- A Human revolution
 - B Knowledge transfer
 - C Contemplative wisdom
 - D Selfless action
33. _____ describes impediments to our Buddhist practice that are due to difficult circumstances into which we are born or have come to live. These are considered adverse rewards or reckoning that stem from bad karma formed in the past lifetimes. The Daishonin associates these with opposition coming from people whose wishes one is bound to follow such as the sovereign of one's nation and one's parents. Fill in the blank.
- A The obstacle of earthly desires
 - B The obstacle of karma
 - C The obstacle of retribution
 - D The hindrance of earthly desires

34. The Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of asuras.”
A Hell B Hunger C Animality D Perversity
35. Which is the life state where one is ruled by the law of the jungle, a struggle for survival in which one is willing to harm others to stay alive, with no sense of reason or conscience?
A Hell B Hunger C Animality D Anger
36. In the Soka Gakkai, the writings of _____, who practised and embodied the essence of the Lotus Sutra, serve as documentary proof. Fill in the blank.
A Nichiren Daishonin B Nichinyo Shonin C Nikken Abe D Nissho Shonin
37. Daishonin writes, “_____ is the world of human beings.”
A Greed B Foolishness C Rage D Calmness
38. On July 16, 1260, he submitted his treatise to Hojo Tokiyori the regent of Kamakura military government. This known as
A First remonstrance B Second Remonstrance C Third Remonstrance D Kosen Rufu
39. “As practice progresses and understanding grows, _____ emerge in confusing form, vying with one another to interfere... One should be neither influenced nor frightened by them.” Fill in the blank.
A Three Obstacles and Four Devils B Three Powerful Enemies C Ten troops D Ten Demon daughters
40. “What we had previously viewed as destiny, we come to see as _____. There is absolutely no way we cannot overcome sufferings.” Fill in the blank.
A Suffering B Legacy C Past offences D Mission

Answers

Mark honestly. The topic that gave you the most trouble is the one to revisit — not the paper as a whole.

MOCK PAPER 1

1 C	2 B	3 C	4 A	5 D	6 B	7 A	8 B	9 A	10 B	11 C	12 B
13 A	14 D	15 A	16 A	17 B	18 B	19 A	20 B	21 C	22 A	23 C	24 A
25 B	26 B	27 A	28 D	29 A	30 B	31 A	32 A	33 D	34 B	35 A	36 A
37 C	38 A	39 C	40 D	41 A	42 A	43 A	44 C	45 A	46 D	47 D	48 C
49 C	50 A	51 C	52 D	53 A	54 A	55 C	56 B	57 B	58 D	59 A	60 B
61 D	62 B	63 C	64 A	65 A	66 C	67 D	68 A	69 A	70 D		

MOCK PAPER 2

1 A	2 D	3 B	4 C	5 A	6 A	7 A	8 B	9 B	10 B	11 C	12 D
13 C	14 D	15 D	16 D	17 C	18 C	19 D	20 C	21 D	22 A	23 D	24 B
25 B	26 B	27 A	28 C	29 C	30 C	31 D	32 D	33 A	34 A	35 D	36 D
37 B	38 A	39 C	40 A	41 D	42 A	43 B	44 B	45 A	46 B	47 B	48 C
49 A	50 C	51 A	52 A	53 A	54 B	55 C	56 A	57 A	58 B	59 C	60 D
61 D	62 C	63 B	64 A	65 A	66 B	67 C	68 C	69 A	70 A		

MOCK PAPER 3

1 A	2 A	3 A	4 A	5 B	6 C	7 B	8 A	9 B	10 C	11 D	12 A
13 A	14 D	15 A	16 B	17 C	18 A	19 A	20 B	21 B	22 C	23 D	24 B
25 A	26 C	27 A	28 A	29 A	30 B	31 C	32 D	33 A	34 B	35 B	36 D
37 C	38 C	39 B									

MOCK PAPER 4

1 D	2 C	3 B	4 C	5 D	6 A	7 A	8 A	9 B	10 B	11 D	12 D
13 B	14 B	15 C	16 C	17 C	18 B	19 A	20 A	21 C	22 B	23 B	24 A
25 C	26 A	27 C	28 B	29 A	30 B	31 B	32 B	33 A	34 B	35 A	36 C
37 B	38 A	39 C	40 D	41 B	42 A	43 B	44 D	45 A	46 A	47 C	48 D
49 C	50 B	51 A	52 D	53 C	54 C	55 B	56 A	57 A	58 A	59 D	60 B
61 D											

EXAM-CONDITION PAPER A

1 A	2 A	3 A	4 D	5 B	6 A	7 B	8 B	9 D	10 D	11 B	12 A
13 B	14 A	15 D	16 A	17 D	18 A	19 A	20 D	21 C	22 D	23 A	24 C
25 A	26 A	27 A	28 B	29 D	30 C	31 B	32 A	33 B	34 A	35 B	36 C
37 A	38 B	39 B	40 C								

EXAM-CONDITION PAPER B

1 C	2 B	3 A	4 D	5 C	6 D	7 A	8 A	9 C	10 C	11 B	12 C
13 A	14 B	15 A	16 A	17 A	18 C	19 B	20 C	21 D	22 B	23 C	24 B
25 C	26 B	27 C	28 B	29 B	30 C	31 A	32 A	33 C	34 D	35 C	36 A
37 D	38 A	39 A	40 D								